UNIT 7

PROPERTIES OF MATTER

Many of the greatest advances that have been made from the beginning of the world to the present time have been made in the earnest desire to turn the knowledge of the properties of matter to some purpose useful to mankind– Lord Kelvin

Learning Objectives

In this unit, the student is exposed to

- inter atomic or intermolecular forces in matter
- stress, strain and elastic modulus
- surface tension
- viscosity
- properties of fluids and their applications

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7.1 INTRODUCTION

One of the oldest dams in the world is Kallanai (கல்லணை) located at Trichy. Kallanai was built across river Kaveri for the purpose of irrigation. During heavy floods, the velocity of water is generally very high in river Kaveri. The stability and utility of Kallanai dam reveal the intuitive scientific understanding of Tamils who designed this dam as early as 2nd century AD. The other example known for insightful constructions of the past is the pyramids in Egypt. The flyovers and overbridges are common worldwide today. Heavy vehicles ply over and hence, the bridges are always under stress. Without effective design using suitable materials, the bridges and flyovers will not



Kallanai (கல்லணை)

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